

WITHDRAWAL, LEAVE OF ABSENCE & SUSPENSION

Purpose:

This policy outlines under what conditions a student may request a withdrawal or leave of absence from the University, as well administrative separations due to breaches of the student code of conduct and/or academic issues. This policy also outlines steps to return to the university within each category.

Scope:

This policy is applicable to all currently enrolled students.

Definitions:

"Withdrawal" means a separation denoting that the student has decided to leave the University without the intention to return to Bucknell at a later date.

"Leave of Absence" means a short-term separation denoting that the student has decided to leave the University for personal reasons such as financial, military service, missionary service, an internship, or assessment of future educational and professional plans.

"Expulsion" means a permanent separation from the University.

"Medical Leave" means a separation denoting that the student has been approved to temporarily leave the University for health-related reasons.

"Administrative Leave" means a separation imposed by the appropriate college Dean's Office to denote that a student had not requested to Withdraw, take a Leave of Absence or been Suspended, but did not return to Campus or is not meeting academic requirements to remain on Campus.

"Academic Suspension" means a separation denoting that a student must temporarily leave the University as imposed by the appropriate academic Associate Dean of their college for reasons including, but not limited to:

- A. lack of attendance,
- B. academic misconduct, or
- C. GPA and/or credits below University requirements.

"Disciplinary Suspension" means a separation denoting that the student must temporarily leave the University as imposed by the Dean of Students as a result of Student Code of Conduct violations or other disciplinary reasons.

"Behavioral Suspension" means a separation denoting that the student must temporarily leave the University as imposed by the Dean of Students as a result of behavioral reasons that may or may not rise to the level of Student Code of Conduct violations.

"Campus" includes any property owned, leased, or controlled by the University, including but not limited to campus housing, academic, administrative and auxiliary buildings, athletics complexes and facilities.

Policy:

- A. The forms of separation recognized by the University include Withdrawal, Leave of Absence and Suspension.
 - 1. Withdrawal denotes that the student does not intend to return to Bucknell
 - 2. Students on Leave of Absence or under Suspension are expected to return to complete their degree requirements
- B. Students subject to any separation covered by this policy may not:
 - 1. attend classes,
 - 2. participate as a member of a student organization or athletic team, or
 - 3. be on Campus for any reason without prior written permission from the Dean of Students.
- C. Separations occurring after the start of the semester may result in the loss of some or all tuition & fees (see [Credit and Refund Policy](#) and [Finance and Financial Aid Information](#)). Students who receive financial aid should contact the Office of Financial Aid at finaid@bucknell.edu to determine any impacts. Failing to do so may result in a loss of financial aid.

Withdrawal[Copy Link](#)

- A. Students who Withdrawl from the University will not retain access to their Bucknell email or other online Univeity resources
- B. Requesting a Withdrawal
 - 1. Students considering a Withdrawal from Bucknell should complete the online Withdrawal Request form found [here](#).
 - a. Students may not Withdraw in order to avoid student conduct, academic misconduct or other disciplinary proceedings, and a Withdrawal is not effective until approved by the relevant administrative office.
 - 2. A Withdrawal after the first two weeks of classes of the semester (after the drop-add period ends) will result in the recording of a grade of W for each course. Grades of W are not factored into the student's GPA.
- C. Reinstatement from a Withdrawal
 - 1. A student who has Withdrawn from Bucknell but has not enrolled as a full-time student at another institution and who wishes to be considered for reinstatement to Bucknell must submit a written request to their college Dean's Office, before June 1 for a fall semester, Nov. 1 for a spring semester, and March 1 for a summer session.
 - 2. A student who has Withdrawn from Bucknell and subsequently enrolls as a full-time student at another institution and who wishes to return to Bucknell must apply using the same process as students applying to transfer to Bucknell detailed [here](#).

Leave of Absence

- A. Students on Leave of Absence will retain access to their Bucknell email and some other online University resources
- B. Requesting a Leave of Absence
 - 1. A student who wishes to request a Leave of Absence should complete the online Leave Request form found [here](#).
 - a. Students may not take a Leave of Absence to avoid student conduct, academic misconduct or other disciplinary proceedings.
 - 2. The request to take a Leave of Absence must be initiated on or before the last day of classes for the semester. A Leave of Absence taken after the first two weeks of classes of the semester (after the drop-add period ends) will result in a grade of W for each course. Grades of W are not factored into the student's GPA.
 - 3. During a Leave of Absence, students wishing to take academic courses elsewhere to transfer credits back to Bucknell must receive prior written permission from the appropriate college Dean's Office. No more than two courses per semester will be approved to transfer credits back to Bucknell.
 - 4. If a student intends to enroll as a full-time student at another institution and not return to the University, the student must complete the online Withdrawal Request form found [here](#).
- C. Reinstatement from a Leave of Absence
 - 1. Students that are ready to resume their studies must initiate a request for reinstatement by completing the following form ([new etrieve form](#)), which is forwarded to the appropriate office for review. Once approved, the student will receive an email notification with next steps related to course registration, housing and financial aid.

Administrative Leave

- A. During an Administrative Leave, students wishing to take academic courses elsewhere to transfer credits back to Bucknell must receive prior written permission from the appropriate college Dean's Office. No more than two courses per semester will be approved to transfer credits back to Bucknell.
- B. Reinstatement from an Administrative Leave
 - 1. Students that are ready to resume their studies must initiate a request for reinstatement by completing the following form ([new etrieve form](#)), which is forwarded to the student's college Dean's Office who will review and follow up accordingly. Once approved the student will receive an email notification with next steps related to course registration, housing and financial aid.

Medical Leave

- A. Requesting Medical Leave

1. Medical Leave requires support from Bucknell Student Health or the Counseling & Student Development Center and is initiated by the Dean of Students or their designee.
 - a. Bucknell Student Health or the Counseling & Student Development Center will consider supporting a student's request for a Medical Leave during a semester based on physical health/illness or mental health reasons, respectively, if the student has been actively engaged in treatment/counseling with one of these offices or another clinician/agency.
 - b. If a student has not been engaged in treatment/counseling, Bucknell Student Health or the Counseling & Student Development Center will assist the student in efforts to obtain the necessary assessment.
 - i. This assessment may be with Bucknell Student Health or the Counseling & Student Development Center, with a provider/clinician in the community, or with a provider/clinician at home.
2. Medical Leave approved after the second week (after the drop-add period ends) will result in a grade of W for each course. Grades of W are not factored into the student's GPA.
3. During Medical Leave, students wishing to take academic courses elsewhere to transfer credits back to Bucknell must receive prior written permission from the appropriate college Dean's Office. No more than two course credits per semester will be approved to transfer credits back to Bucknell.

B. Evaluation and Treatment Expectation during a Medical Leave

1. During Medical Leave, the University expects the student to be evaluated by a professional health care provider in order to determine whether a student may return to a University-owned residence and/or full-time academic study. Failure to engage in appropriate treatment may seriously jeopardize the student's ability to return and be successful at Bucknell. The University may withhold reinstatement until appropriate treatment or intervention has been obtained.
2. Bucknell may require that the student's off-campus primary health care provider make contact with the University to discuss the nature of the problem that led to the student's taking Medical Leave. To facilitate this communication, the student may be required to provide written permission for Bucknell staff to communicate with the student's third party healthcare provider.

C. Reinstatement from a Medical Leave

1. Typically, Medical Leave requires, at least, one complete semester or the equivalent (i.e., at least four months) to pass before the student may return to Bucknell
2. Medical Leave approved after the first four weeks of the semester typically requires the student's absence from the University for, at least, one complete regular semester before consideration will be given for reinstatement. This is intended to allow the student adequate time to address the issues that necessitated the Medical Leave
3. The University will perform an individualized assessment of the student's situation in making decisions about the timing of a student's return.
4. The request to return from Medical Leave (new etrieve form) should be received by Bucknell by October 1 for reinstatement for a spring semester and March 15 for reinstatement for a fall semester.
 - a. Students may be required to provide written releases to both Bucknell and student's third-party healthcare providers to communicate freely in order to support the student.
5. If a student has not met all criteria for reinstatement until after the above-stated deadlines, but does so before the start of the upcoming semester, the request for reinstatement may be considered on a case-by-case basis and will depend on many factors, including course and housing availability.
6. If a student is accepted for reinstatement, housing and course selection may be limited due to the timing of the decision allowing the return. Students should direct any questions about the Medical Leave and reinstatement process to the Dean of Students Office.

Suspension

A. Academic Suspension

1. A student may be placed on Academic Suspension for one academic year, or in exceptional circumstances, one semester, as a result of poor academic performance over a single or several semesters.
2. An Academic Suspension imposed after the first two weeks of classes of the semester (after the drop-add period ends) will result in the recording of a grade of W for each course. Grades of W will not be factored into the student's GPA.
3. During an Academic Suspension, students wishing to take academic courses elsewhere to transfer credits back to Bucknell must receive prior written permission from the appropriate academic Associate Dean of their college. No more than two courses per semester will be approved to transfer credits back to Bucknell.

B. Disciplinary Suspension

1. A student may be placed on Disciplinary Suspension as the result of the Student Conduct Process.
2. The written statement sanctioning the student with a Disciplinary Suspension shall include:
 - a. the date when the Disciplinary Suspension shall take effect,
 - b. the earliest date that the student is eligible for reinstatement at the University, and
 - c. any conditions that must be met before reinstatement is granted.
3. A Disciplinary Suspension imposed after the first two weeks of classes of the semester (after the drop-add period ends) will result in the recording of a grade of W for each course. Grades of W will not be factored into the student's GPA.
4. A student placed on a Disciplinary Suspension may not transfer any academic credit completed within the period of suspension from other institutions of higher education.

C. Behavioral Suspension

1. Following a behavioral assessment, the Dean of Students reserves the right to require a separation for a student who engages in certain disruptive conduct, including, but not limited to:
 - a. Engaging or threatening to engage in conduct posing a danger of harm to self or others.
 - b. Engaging or threatening to engage in conduct causing significant property damage, which directly and substantially impedes the lawful activities of other members of the University.
 - c. Demonstrating a failure to fulfill personal needs (e.g., nourishment, shelter), leading to a good-faith determination that serious physical harm or death, serious negative impact on the well-being of other students, or serious disruption of University operations is likely to occur.
 - d. Committing a violation of the University's Student Conduct Code and demonstrates an inability to effectively participate in the University's disciplinary process.
2. A Behavioral Suspension imposed after the first two weeks of classes of the semester (after the drop-add period ends) will result in the recording of a grade of W for each course. Grades of W will not be factored into the student's GPA.

3. A student placed on a Behavioral Suspension will typically not be permitted to transfer any academic credit completed within the period of the leave from other institutions of higher education.
- D. Reinstatement from Academic, Disciplinary or Behavioral Suspension
1. A student placed on Academic, Disciplinary or Behavioral Suspension from the University may initiate a request for reinstatement by completing the following form **(new retrieve form)**, which is forwarded to the student's college Dean's Office or Dean of Students who will review the request and follow up accordingly. Once approved for reinstatement, the student will receive an email notification with next steps related to course registration, housing and financial aid.
 2. Reinstatement requests should include:
 - a. a written statement in which the student addresses how they have spent their time away from the University,
 - b. highlight areas of change for the better with a focus on how they have addressed the academic and/or behavioral concern that resulted in their leave, and
 - c. Any additional supporting documentation that is required as a condition of their reinstatement in accordance with this policy.
 3. A request for reinstatement from an Academic, Disciplinary or Behavioral Suspension should be received by Bucknell by June 1 for a fall semester, November 1 for a spring semester, and March 1 for a summer session.
 4. The Dean of Students may refer students applying for reinstatement from a Behavioral Suspension for a behavioral assessment if they believe a more comprehensive assessment of the student's eligibility for return is required.
 5. A student who is reinstated to the University after a period of Disciplinary Suspension may not apply for on-campus housing or register for classes until after the last semester of their imposed Disciplinary Suspension has concluded.

Expulsion

- A. An expulsion is effective immediately and no academic credit may be earned for the semester in which an expulsion is imposed. Students who are separated through expulsion have no more than 24 hours from the date of the decision to vacate Campus, unless otherwise noted by the Dean of Students.
- B. Record of a student's expulsion is maintained in both the Office of the Dean of Students and the Office of the University Registrar.